

Germany: Länder flags



MECKLENBURG-VORPOMMERN

This flag, adopted in 1991, combines blue and white of Pomerania with blue, yellow, and red of Mecklenburg. The bull and the gryphon are also local emblems. Red and white recall the Hanseatic League.



RHINELAND-PALATINATE

The flag was adopted in 1948 when the arms were placed on the national flag. The coat of arms depicts the lion of the Palatinate dating from 1229, the cross of Trier from 1273, and the wheel of Mainz from 1335.



SAXONY

The flag was adopted in 1991, but the coat of arms is the traditional arms of the rulers of Saxony; black and yellow bands and the green crown of rue. The white and green flag dates from the 19th century.



SCHLESWIG-HOLSTEIN

The shield depicts two lions from arms of Schleswig and a nettle-leaf from those of Holstein. The colors of the flag, adopted in 1957, are taken from the arms.



NORTH-RHINE-WESTPHALIA

The coat of arms depicts the River Rhine of the Rhineland, the horse of Westphalia, and the rose of Lippe; the three territories which united to form the state. The colors of the flag are from the arms.



SAARLAND

Adopted in 1957, the flag of Saarland recalls the different parts of the state. Depicted on the shield is the lion of Saarbrücken, the cross of Trier, the eagles of Lorraine and the lion of Pfalz-Zweibrücken.



SAXONY-ANHALT

This flag was the same as Baden-Württemberg until 1991, when the colors were reversed. The eagle recalls Prussia, the bicolored bands and rue crown, Saxony, and the bear and wall are the arms of Anhalt.



THURINGIA

Another flag whose colors are based on the state arms. It was adopted in 1991. The red and white lion was the arms of the Counts of Thuringia in the 12th century.